

MANM389

DISSERTATION FOR BUSINESS ANALYTICS

This form must be included as an appendix in your dissertation.

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Research Topic: Gap between donor support and sustainable development goals for artisanal small scale mining industry in Sub-Saharan Africa

RESEARCH OVERVIEW (400 WORDS)

i In many parts of the world, artisanal small scale mining (ASM) activities are at least as significant as large-scale mining industry in terms of the number of people it employs. One of the vital roles it plays is in terms of alleviating poverty, rural development, providing employment to over 40 million people living in impoverished areas in lower-income countries across the developing world (World Bank, 2019). Providing the world with essential raw materials to manufacture luxury goods and other critical metals that are needed for the transition towards a lower carbon economy (World Bank, 2017; 2020), forces the ASM industry to employ all available sources of labor like women, men, girls, and boys (Hilson, 2009; Cartier & Burge, 2011; Hilson & McQuilken, 2014; Franks, Pakoun & Ngonze, 2016; Stylo, de Haan & Davis, 2020). With being such an important sector, it stands to reason that ASM crosses across the SDGs set by the United Nations. When large-scale mining activities incorporate foreign investment, the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) may be achieved via the promotion of economic development and the eradication of poverty in developing nations. This is because such an industry requires substantial capital expenditure. The small-scale mining sector, however, has not produced particularly outstanding outcomes. This is due to the enclave-like structure of large-scale resource extraction, the difficulty to catalyze linkages and downstream/upstream growth, and the fact that firms get substantial tax breaks and are not required to engage in the local community (Hilson and Maconachie, 2020). According to the Atlas, industrial-scale mining: "has also contributed to a significant number of the problems that the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) aim to address. Despite this, Atlas makes extensive and, at times, excessive efforts to highlight the economic importance of the sector's operations in their totality. The report outlines, for instance, how the industry employs 2.5 million people worldwide, how it can stimulate the growth of infrastructure and innovation, and how it may bring investment to rural places and relieve poverty there " on a game-changing scale across extended time horizons (Hilson et al., 2018)." In other words, Atlas asserts that "mining and metals play a significant role in the SDG agenda," which is backed by the arguments (Maconachie and Conteh, 2021). In reality, the greatest flaw is its peculiar decision to disregard the importance of artisanal and small-scale mining (ASM) within the context of the Sustainable Development Goals.

RESEARCH QUESTIONS (300 WORDS)



Q1. How do donors help the small-scale mining industry to grow and contribute to the achievement of the United Nations' sustainable development goals?

Q2. What are the trends and patterns identified between the donor support and the miner's goals and objectives that result in a gap?

Q3. What effective business strategies can small-scale miners in Africa employ to maximize their profitability, enhance their market penetration, and guarantee their long-term sustainability?

METHODOLOGY (150 WORDS)



A survey is scheduled in 2021, to gather data from the miners in the small scale mining industry (Hilson, 2020). The target population of the survey is the small scale miners of the industry from the areas of Malawi, Liberia and Sierra Leone. Since the survey has already been done, secondary data analysis will be used as a research method. The responses will be analyzed with R programming to perform pre-processing tasks such as data cleaning. The next step of analysis, data visualization will be done using Tableau. Through this tool, dashboards will be created to graphically represent the survey responses and will result in data-driven insights which will be analyzed. In the report, the dataset will be thoroughly discussed, along with identifying patterns and gaps in research. Results will be discussed that will focus on the different innovation techniques and business strategies that the miners can incorporate in order to ultimately achieve the sustainable development goals.

SIGNIFICANCE OF RESEARCH (150 WORDS)



This research is a direct reaction to this critical omission; it utilizes a case study from sub-Saharan Africa to illustrate how a strengthened and better-regulated ASM sector may contribute to and meet the SDGs' goals. Host governments "have embedded the SDGs into national development strategies" (Eniowo et al., 2022), convinced that the goals provide the previously elusive comprehensive and flexible framework required to address the complex problems that Africa faces today. Women are still faced with increased rates of sexual and gender-based violence, 41% of the population now lives on less than \$1.25 a day (Hilson, 2020), one-third of children between the ages of 12 and 14 are not in school, and more than half of those between the ages of 15 and 17 are not in school (Hilson and Maconachie, 2020); these are just a few of the challenges that need urgent attention and attract the need to perform this research.

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